

Project: Employee Onboarding Process Improvement

Purpose: The Five Whys Analysis was conducted to identify the underlying root causes contributing to delayed employee onboarding. The analysis focuses on the most significant issues identified during stakeholder interviews, document review, and the Fishbone Diagram.

Root Cause Analysis 1

Problem Statement: Employee onboarding takes longer than expected due to delayed approvals.

Why	Analysis
Why 1	Hiring managers do not approve onboarding requests promptly.
Why 2	Approval requests compete with other daily priorities.
Why 3	There are no defined approval turnaround expectations.
Why 4	Approval ownership and accountability are not consistently monitored.
Why 5	The onboarding process lacks governance over cross-functional approvals.

Validated Root Cause: Lack of governance and accountability for cross-functional approval timelines.

Root Cause Analysis 2

Problem Statement: Multiple teams request the same information from employees.

Why	Analysis
Why 1	Different teams collect information independently.
Why 2	Teams do not share onboarding information.
Why 3	Systems used by HR, IT and other functions are disconnected.
Why 4	There is no centralized onboarding tracker or shared workflow.
Why 5	The onboarding process has evolved independently across departments without integrated process design.

Validated Root Cause: Absence of an integrated onboarding workflow and centralized information management.

Root Cause Analysis 3

Problem Statement: Background verification delays employee onboarding.

Why	Analysis
Why 1	Background verification requires several days to complete.
Why 2	The external vendor must verify information before completion.
Why 3	Verification cannot begin until required documents are submitted.
Why 4	Document submission is sometimes delayed or incomplete.
Why 5	There is limited visibility into document status and follow-up responsibilities.

Validated Root Cause: Limited visibility and dependency management for external verification activities.

Root Cause Analysis 4

Problem Statement: Stakeholders have limited visibility into onboarding progress.

Why	Analysis
Why 1	Stakeholders cannot easily track onboarding status.
Why 2	Each department maintains its own records.
Why 3	There is no common onboarding dashboard.
Why 4	No standardized tracking mechanism has been implemented.
Why 5	Process ownership focuses on departmental activities rather than end-to-end onboarding performance.

Validated Root Cause: Lack of end-to-end process ownership supported by standardized tracking and reporting.

Summary of Validated Root Causes

ID	Validated Root Cause
RC-01	Lack of governance and accountability for approval timelines
RC-02	Absence of an integrated onboarding workflow and centralized information management
RC-03	Limited visibility and dependency management for external verification activities
RC 04	Lack of end-to-end process ownership supported by standardized tracking and reporting

